



MMA League Table

Computer Science NEA

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Contents

Identified a substantial problem	2
Broad aims of the project.....	3
Limitations of a solution to the problem	Error! Bookmark not defined.
Feedback and refinement to the proposed solution.....	4

Identified a substantial problem

My Problem

In the sport of Mixed Martial Arts, most of the time the fights that are made rely on league rankings which in the case of the UFC (the most popular promotion), are decided from a vote made by over 20 people from various MMA networks. This has a few problems, however.

Firstly, the main problem with the way that the system works is that it is very open to corruption. For example, some organizations will want to make certain fights more appealing and coherent to fans so they will like the fights more when they're announced. Another example is that an MMA organization will sometimes stop someone from having a contender/title fight since the fans do not like them enough or the fans like the champion more. Even though the fans may not like the contender, not letting them fight is a failure to what is meant to be an unscripted and unrestricted sport.

Secondly, the use of humans to decide the rank change is very time-consuming and inefficient. As said before, it takes over 20 people to do the rankings, and it also takes around 48 hours to update the rankings (and that's the UFC which is the biggest promoter in MMA). If you gave a single computer this task, I highly doubt that it would take more than 20 minutes to give good rankings.

Thirdly, I also think that due to the use of humans the rankings are very open to error. This is a bigger problem on the frontend, where there are only a few people responsible for the rank changes. If these people, make a small error and it goes unnoticed it is not fair for someone who is working to go up the ranks.

Fourthly, the larger official MMA rankings, like the ones on the UFC website have no way to filter a table, and if they do its probably by not a lot of factors. Ideally, the rank tables should be able to be sorted by Nationality, Fighting Style, Age Etc.

Finally, most fighters in the larger promotions don't even have an official rank. Meaning the fans of these fighters and the fighters themselves don't really have a proper metric to see how they are against their fellow fighters and can't see how close they are to being ranked.

Broad aims and limitations of the project

My Aims

- The main goal of my project is to make a system that inputs fighter data and turns it into a league table that is as accurate as possible.
- The table will show the descending rankings and each fighter's main info such as the name and a picture of them.
- You should be able to sort this league table by factors such as nationality and age.
- To improve the user experience, I will also make a fighter page where you can see the information and statistics of an individual fighter. This will help with the context of each of the rankings.
- The user will be able to put in parameters and find out what fights are likely to be the most entertaining. This means that people will know what fights they need to look out for and to see if it is worth it to buy a Pay Per View card.
- The user will be able to enter two fighters and will be given the odds if they were to fight. This can be used to see the odds for future events or even just for hypotheticals.

My Limitations

- Importing the data of the fighters into the database will be tedious, especially if you're importing all the fighters in a promotion.
- Fighter data can be not up-to-date or complete
- Fights can be very unpredictable because of things like the fighter's personal life and injuries affecting their performance, meaning that odds will be quite hard to predict and it will be hard to predict what fights are going to be entertaining or not.
- A fight being entertaining or not can be quite subjective because different people will want different things
- In the grand scheme of things in MMA, the table doesn't matter because the promotion you're generating the table for can make whatever fights they want to make.
- It's a bit of a legal grey area to use the information and photos of fighters due to data protection laws.
- The system may not be able to keep up with a larger amount of data if this was applied to a whole league i.e. searches would be slow.

Feedback and refinement to the proposed solution.

FEEDBACK

SUGGESTIONS FROM CLASS

RESPONSE

It will be hard to input the data.

I will have to look for an API that can automate putting fighter/fight data into the database.

The odds may be hard and unreliable.

I will have to study and then integrate the odds algorithms that are already used and proven into my code.

The entertainment factor of each fight is very subjective.

I could add a survey where you tell the system what you prefer and what you don't, and this survey can be put into an algorithm to show you what fights you'll find the most entertaining.

It will be annoying to do a survey repeatedly.

I will make it so you can have a profile where you can store the results of your survey

You could allow people to vote on a fighter as to show if they think the fighter is entertaining or not.